# JLPT N1

## Complete Study Guide

Japanese Language Proficiency Test — Advanced Level

*~2,000 Kanji • ~10,000 Vocabulary • Advanced Grammar • Classical Japanese*

N1 is the highest JLPT level, equivalent to near-native proficiency. This book focuses on the advanced vocabulary, grammar, and reading strategies unique to N1. Use together with all lower-level books for complete preparation.

# Chapter 1: N1 Overview

Sections: Language Knowledge — Vocabulary (35 min) | Grammar + Reading (110 min) | Listening (60 min) Total Score: 180 points | Passing: 100 points, min 19 per section N1 reading includes long essays, editorials, academic papers, and complex narratives.

# Chapter 2: N1 Vocabulary

Literary, formal, academic, and specialized vocabulary introduced at N1 level.

## Philosophy & Ideas (20)

| Kanji / Word | Reading | Meaning | Type |
|---|---|---|---|
| 文明 | ぶんめい | civilization | *Noun* |
| 思想 | しそう | thought, ideology | *Noun* |
| 哲学 | てつがく | philosophy | *Noun* |
| 倫理 | りんり | ethics, morality | *Noun* |
| 道徳 | どうとく | morality | *Noun* |
| 価値観 | かちかん | value system, values | *Noun* |
| 世界観 | せかいかん | world view | *Noun* |
| 人生観 | じんせいかん | outlook on life | *Noun* |
| 信念 | しんねん | belief, conviction | *Noun* |
| 原則 | げんそく | principle, rule | *Noun* |
| 規範 | きはん | standard, norm | *Noun* |
| 慣行 | かんこう | custom, practice | *Noun* |
| 慣習 | かんしゅう | custom, convention | *Noun* |
| 制裁 | せいさい | sanction, penalty | *Noun* |
| 統治 | とうち | governance, rule | *Noun* |
| 秩序 | ちつじょ | order, discipline | *Noun* |
| 混乱 | こんらん | confusion, disorder | *Noun* |
| 矛盾 | むじゅん | contradiction | *Noun* |
| 逆説 | ぎゃくせつ | paradox | *Noun* |
| 比喩 | ひゆ | metaphor, analogy | *Noun* |

## Academic & Cognitive (12)

| Kanji / Word | Reading | Meaning | Type |
|---|---|---|---|
| 認識 | にんしき | recognition, awareness | *Noun* |
| 知覚 | ちかく | perception | *Noun* |
| 概念 | がいねん | concept | *Noun* |

| Kanji / Word | Reading | Meaning | Type |
|---|---|---|---|
| 抽象 | ちゅうしょう | abstraction | *Noun* |
| 具象 | ぐしょう | concrete form | *Noun* |
| 象徴 | しょうちょう | symbol | *Noun* |
| 暗示 | あんじ | implication, hint | *Noun* |
| 前提 | ぜんてい | premise | *Noun* |
| 結論 | けつろん | conclusion | *Noun* |
| 帰結 | きけつ | consequence, result | *Noun* |
| 因果関係 | いんがかんけい | causal relationship | *Noun* |
| 相関関係 | そうかんかんけい | correlation | *Noun* |

## Social Issues (Advanced) (12)

| Kanji / Word | Reading | Meaning | Type |
|---|---|---|---|
| 格差社会 | かくさしゃかい | gap society, unequal society | *Noun* |
| 貧困 | ひんこん | poverty | *Noun* |
| 福祉 | ふくし | welfare | *Noun* |
| 社会保障 | しゃかいほしょう | social security | *Noun* |
| 保育 | ほいく | childcare | *Noun* |
| 介護 | かいご | nursing care | *Noun* |
| 少子高齢化 | しょうしこうれいか | falling birthrate and aging | *Noun* |
| 移民 | いみん | immigration, immigrant | *Noun* |
| 難民 | なんみん | refugee | *Noun* |
| 人権 | じんけん | human rights | *Noun* |
| 民族 | みんぞく | ethnic group, people | *Noun* |
| 宗教 | しゅうきょう | religion | *Noun* |

## Economy & Policy (Advanced) (8)

| Kanji / Word | Reading | Meaning | Type |
|---|---|---|---|
| グローバリゼーション | グローバリゼーション | globalization | *Noun* |

| Kanji / Word | Reading | Meaning | Type |
|---|---|---|---|
| 市場経済 | しじょうけいざい | market economy | *Noun* |
| 独占 | どくせん | monopoly | *Noun* |
| 規制緩和 | きせいかんわ | deregulation | *Noun* |
| 構造改革 | こうぞうかいかく | structural reform | *Noun* |
| 財政赤字 | ざいせいあかじ | fiscal deficit | *Noun* |
| 国債 | こくさい | government bonds | *Noun* |
| 経済成長率 | けいざいせいちょうりつ | economic growth rate | *Noun* |

## Science (Advanced) (10)

| Kanji / Word | Reading | Meaning | Type |
|---|---|---|---|
| 進化 | しんか | evolution | *Noun* |
| 遺伝子 | いでんし | gene | *Noun* |
| ゲノム | ゲノム | genome | *Noun* |
| 細胞 | さいぼう | cell (biology) | *Noun* |
| 量子 | りょうし | quantum | *Noun* |
| 素粒子 | そりゅうし | elementary particle | *Noun* |
| 宇宙 | うちゅう | universe, space | *Noun* |
| 銀河 | ぎんが | galaxy | *Noun* |
| 人工知能 | じんこうちのう | artificial intelligence | *Noun* |
| 機械学習 | きかいがくしゅう | machine learning | *Noun* |

## Literary & Aesthetic (6)

| Kanji / Word | Reading | Meaning | Type |
|---|---|---|---|
| 趣 | おもむき | taste, elegance, atmosphere | *Noun* |
| 情緒 | じょうちょ | emotion, atmosphere | *Noun* |
| 風情 | ふぜい | elegance, taste | *Noun* |
| 余韻 | よいん | lingering sound/impression | *Noun* |
| 含蓄 | がんちく | implication, depth | *Noun* |

| Kanji / Word | Reading | Meaning | Type |
|---|---|---|---|
| 奥深い | おくぶかい | profound, deep | *i-adj* |

## Formal Adverbs (10)

| Kanji / Word | Reading | Meaning | Type |
|---|---|---|---|
| ひいては | ひいては | and consequently, and even | *Adverb* |
| まして | まして | much less, let alone | *Adverb* |
| よもや | よもや | never, by no means | *Adverb* |
| かかる | かかる | such, this kind of | *Adj.* |
| かつて | かつて | once, formerly | *Adverb* |
| とかく | とかく | one way or another, somehow | *Adverb* |
| おのずから | おのずから | naturally, of itself | *Adverb* |
| さながら | さながら | just as if, exactly like | *Adverb* |
| つとに | つとに | long since, early on | *Adverb* |
| ひとしく | ひとしく | equally, alike | *Adverb* |

## na-Adjectives (8)

| Kanji / Word | Reading | Meaning | Type |
|---|---|---|---|
| 深遠な | しんえんな | profound, deep | *na-adj* |
| 卓越した | たくえつした | outstanding, excellent | *na-adj* |
| 微妙な | びみょうな | delicate, subtle | *na-adj* |
| 精巧な | せいこうな | elaborate, precise | *na-adj* |
| 崇高な | すうこうな | sublime, lofty | *na-adj* |
| 脆弱な | ぜいじゃくな | fragile, vulnerable | *na-adj* |
| 過酷な | かこくな | harsh, severe | *na-adj* |
| 緻密な | ちみつな | minute, elaborate | *na-adj* |

## Advanced Verbs (18)

| Kanji / Word | Reading | Meaning | Type |
|---|---|---|---|
| 見なす | みなす | to regard as, consider | *Verb (u)* |

| Kanji / Word | Reading | Meaning | Type |
|---|---|---|---|
| 際立つ | きわだつ | to stand out | *Verb (u)* |
| 浮き彫りにする | うきぼりにする | to highlight, bring into relief | *Verb (irr)* |
| 打ち消す | うちけす | to deny, negate | *Verb (u)* |
| 裏付ける | うらづける | to support, back up | *Verb (ru)* |
| 培う | つちかう | to cultivate, foster | *Verb (u)* |
| 促す | うながす | to urge, encourage | *Verb (u)* |
| 妨げる | さまたげる | to hinder, obstruct | *Verb (ru)* |
| 揺るぐ | ゆるぐ | to shake, waver | *Verb (u)* |
| 覆す | くつがえす | to overturn, overthrow | *Verb (u)* |
| 見極める | みきわめる | to determine, ascertain | *Verb (ru)* |
| 踏まえる | ふまえる | to be based on, take into account | *Verb (ru)* |
| 鑑みる | かんがみる | to consider in light of | *Verb (ru)* |
| もたらす | もたらす | to bring about, cause | *Verb (u)* |
| 孕む | はらむ | to contain, be pregnant with | *Verb (u)* |
| 被る | こうむる | to suffer, incur | *Verb (u)* |
| 抱く | だく・いだく | to hold, embrace, harbor (feelings) | *Verb (u)* |
| 織り込む | おりこむ | to weave in, incorporate | *Verb (u)* |

# Chapter 3: N1 Grammar Patterns

| Pattern | Meaning | Example + Translation |
|---|---|---|
| **〜に他ならない** | Is nothing other than ~, is exactly | これは人々の努力の賜物に他ならない。<br>This is nothing other than the fruit of people's efforts. |
| **〜をもって** | With ~, using ~, as of (date) | これをもって会議を終了します。<br>With this, we conclude the meeting. |
| **〜ずにはいられない** | Cannot help but ~ | その映画を見て泣かずにはいられなかった。<br>I couldn't help crying watching that movie. |
| **〜に至っては** | When it comes to ~, especially | 彼の成績に至っては、クラスで最低だ。<br>When it comes to his grades, they're the worst in class. |
| **〜とは言え** | That said, although | 理解できるとは言え、賛成はできない。<br>That said, even if I understand, I can't agree. |
| **〜ならではの** | Unique to ~, only possible with | 日本ならではの文化がある。<br>There is a culture unique to Japan. |
| **〜にわたって** | Over ~, spanning | 10年にわたって研究してきた。<br>I have been researching for over 10 years. |
| **〜を余儀なくされる** | Be forced to ~ | 廃業を余儀なくされた。<br>We were forced to close down the business. |
| **〜そばから** | As fast as ~ (undone immediately) | 覚えるそばから忘れてしまう。<br>I forget as fast as I learn. |
| **〜あっての** | Made possible by ~, thanks to | お客様あっての商売だ。<br>Business is possible thanks to customers. |
| **〜ないまでも** | Even if not ~, at least | 完璧でないまでも、努力すべきだ。<br>Even if not perfect, one should make an effort. |
| **〜もさることながら** | Not only ~, but also | 実力もさることながら、運も重要だ。<br>Not only skill, but luck is also important. |
| **〜を踏まえて** | Based on ~, taking ~ into account | 現状を踏まえて対策を立てる。<br>We devise measures taking the current situation into account. |
| **〜をものともせず** | Undaunted by ~, in defiance of | 困難をものともせず前進した。<br>He moved forward, undaunted by difficulties. |
| **〜んばかりに** | As if about to ~ | 泣かんばかりの顔をしていた。<br>He had a face as if about to cry. |
| **〜とあれば** | If it is the case that ~ | 必要とあれば、すぐに参ります。<br>If needed, I will come at once. |

| Pattern | Meaning | Example + Translation |
|---|---|---|
| **〜をよそに** | Regardless of ~, ignoring | 周囲の反対をよそに計画を進めた。<br>He proceeded with the plan regardless of the opposition. |
| **〜にして初めて** | Only when ~, not until | 経験にして初めて分かることがある。<br>There are things that can only be understood through experience. |
| **〜べき** | Should ~, ought to | リーダーが率先すべきだ。<br>The leader should take the lead. |
| **〜ざるを得ない** | Cannot but ~, have no choice | 認めざるを得ない。<br>I have no choice but to acknowledge it. |
| **〜ともなると** | When it comes to ~, once it reaches | 社長ともなると責任が重い。<br>Once you become president, responsibility is heavy. |
| **〜いわんや** | Let alone ~, needless to say | 初心者はいわんや、専門家も難しい。<br>Let alone beginners, even experts find it difficult. |
| **〜かたわら** | While ~, alongside | 仕事のかたわら執筆活動をしている。<br>Alongside work, I am engaged in writing. |
| **〜ゆえに** | Therefore ~, due to | 能力があるゆえに嫉妬を受けた。<br>Due to his ability, he was envied. |
| **〜いかんによって** | Depending on ~ | 結果いかんによって報酬が変わる。<br>Remuneration changes depending on the results. |

# Chapter 4: Advanced Reading Strategies

N1 reading passages can be 500–1,000 characters. They include abstract essays, literary criticism, and complex argumentation.

## Rhetorical Devices to Identify

比喩 (ひゆ) — Metaphor and analogy: recognize figurative language 逆説 (ぎゃくせつ) — Paradox: when something seemingly contradictory is true 反語 (はんご) — Rhetorical question: question used for effect 例示 (れいじ) — Exemplification: 「たとえば」「具体的には」signal examples 譲歩 (じょうほ) — Concession: 「〜が/ものの/けれども、しかし〜」

## Paragraph Structure Recognition

Many academic paragraphs follow PEEL: P = Point (主張 - main claim) E = Evidence (根拠 - grounds) E = Elaboration (説明 - expansion) L = Link (接続詞 - connector to next point) On questions: find the topic sentence → look for the connector → identify the author's stance

# Chapter 5: Total Study Roadmap (N5 → N1)

N5: ~3-6 months (daily learner) | ~150-200 hours N4: ~6-12 months from N5 | ~300 hours total N3: ~12-18 months from N5 | ~600 hours total N2: ~2-3 years from N5 | ~1,200 hours total N1: ~4-6 years from N5 | ~2,000-4,000+ hours total  Recommended Resources: • Vocabulary: Anki + official JLPT vocab decks • Grammar: Tobira (N3), Shin Kanzen Master (N2/N1) • Reading: NHK Web Easy (N3), Asahi Shimbun (N2/N1) • Listening: JapanesePod101, shadowing with drama/news • Speaking: HelloTalk, italki with native speakers • Kanji: WaniKani or Remembering the Kanji (RTK)